

- Present day

CHAPTER X - ZONING FOR SUCCESS / PHIL'S DEMISE

"Zoning for success, what's that mean, tricia?" asked Dora when they were munching on the stale lembas bread and swilling chestnut milk and locust bars. Erwin was wolfing down huge chunks of the bread, oblivious to the crumbs scattered in a moon-like creseent around him and on his lapels.

"Zoning for success means that you work only to ~~get PosPoints and to~~ avoid Negbints. It's hard when you have a fickle boss. You don't want to veer into the unsuccesful zone." Tricia uncorked the stopper from a small vial containing dark green flecks. she pulled out of her handbag. "Pocket fluff, she said, "haha," no just kidding its kombu, for vitamin A. I know, it's all poppycock, vitamins are, but my granma lived to a hundred, and she ~~wass~~ always munching the stuff."

"What happens when you zone out of success then?"

"First you go to the twenty-second floor for re-integration," she said, wiping the corner of her mouth with a grey napkin.

- Phil

- switch to the present

- how is he removed → Testing Floor → Corps (Fasiler)

how is AI introduced? Was there a meeting? + someone reading from a screen.

By the new Bylaws? Instructions? Something growing ^{minitel}

How does Phil get his instructions? By tele screen? ~~By~~ or ~~like in~~ by those mail chutes? or a printer.

[the Databox - That's when it happened → Power Surge

→ power outage for the rest - the AI Coup / machines

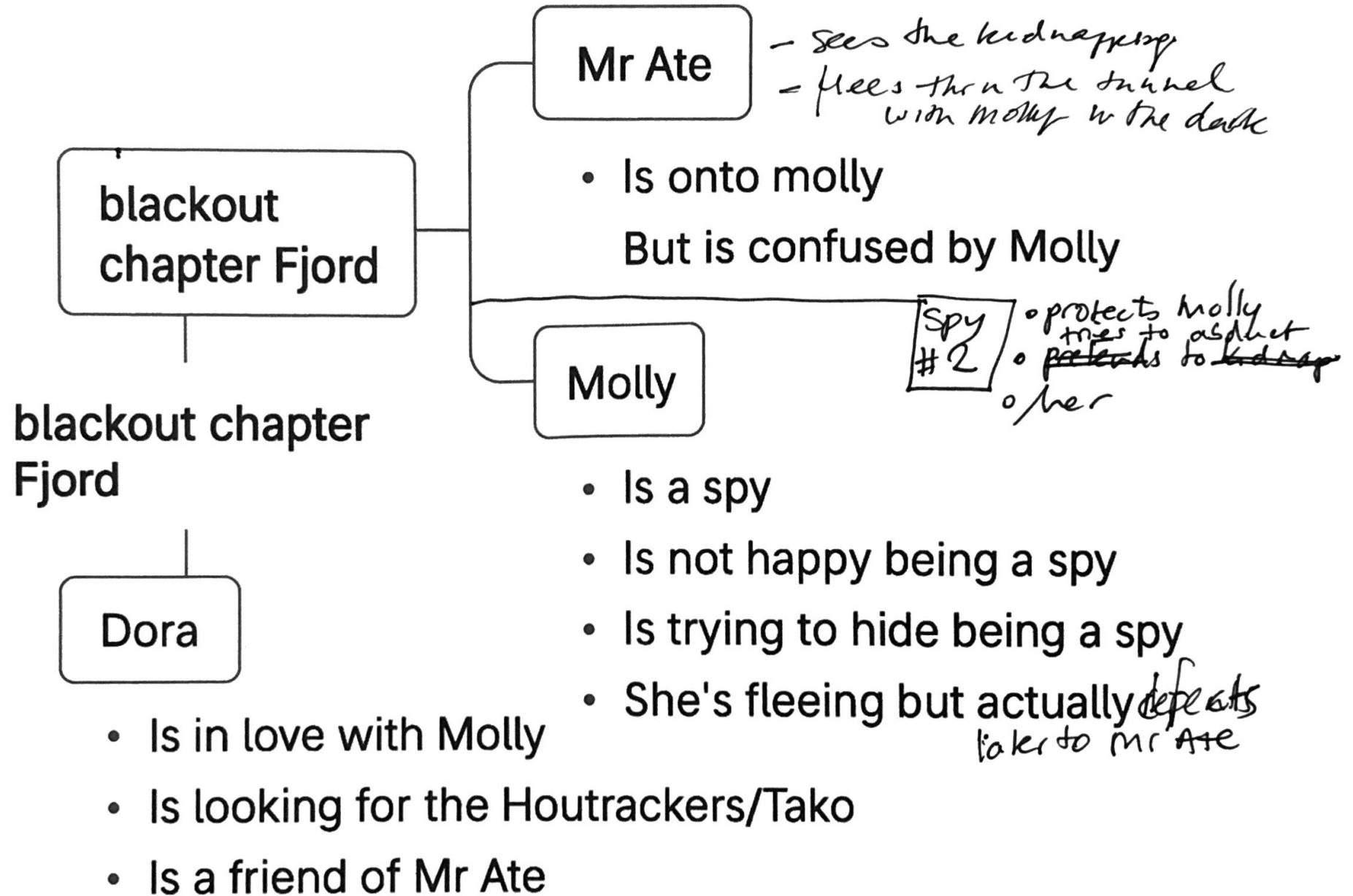
All ~~eng~~ energy → AI.

- the woman = kafka-esque. She Brings a fake note.

- instructions from HR - and Ren Wheeler Room.

- punos before her denied -

- she's arrested, almost ~~delayed~~.



The ageing smoke machine belched erratic clouds of whitish muck over the expectant and fidgety crowd. Dora motioned to Molly to hustle to the front of the stage, as she saw the sound engineer twiddle the last knobs on the guitar amp, and he hustled off-stage. a sure sign things were about to blast off. The famous Houtrakkers, 2BON/2 she was dying to see them outside of their hidey-hole. Were they even of flesh and blood? Hard to tell...

Mr. Ate took to the stage as the crowd yelled and catcalled. "Now announcing the moment you've all been waiting for... I proudly present the best punk rock band since Sonic Youth, 2BON2B!!!" the stage was already hard to make out because of the smoke, now the lights went full on infra red, and the smoke machine full blast - too much for its antiquated circuitry, it roared, belched, and sparked and misted like Krakatoa and the ensuing shortcircuit blew the lights - the crowd was in dismay and it was utter pitch black - Dora could only hear or see a vague residual blink of Mr Ate shooting off pronto to the left of the stage. "Where's he going? Molly, where are the Molly?" there was no molly beside here, only a big punk in a tatty woolen feeling sweater. "Yo I'm no Molly," yeez it's dark, and he lit a lighter. as did other around him. At the bar in the back a flashlight was on and someone was rummaging for matches to promptly light some emergency candles. Dora sped on her axis, Mollu nor mr Ate were anywhere to be seen. "wtf, " she exclaimed, and grabbed her bike light from her pocket. "The john, most likely, " and she ran on the stage, tripping over the spaghetti of cables and fell over the crouching sound engineer who lamented the demise of the mist machine. She tumbled down the back of the stage, through the curtains and suddenly remembered the Cold War bomb shelter tunnel access. "That must be where they went," though wtf, WFT, WFT" she felt around in the dark until she came to the cold steel door, and pushed down hard on the steel jamb and it swung open to more darkness. Dora was suddenly very cold, a tight cold hand constricted her throat and chest, what if Molly ran off with Mr Ate, she ran on into the tunnel which had some old sodium lamps rigged to some battery so she could see her way around she heard footsteps running in a passage way to her right, and she saw a doorway to her left where it was dark. she ran in and hid behind the door, just able to see part of the corridor. It wasn't Mr Ate, nor Molly - it was the hairy punk who had stood right next to her - what a coincidence, she thought. Or was it? He had a powerful flashlight and its narrow beam was almost blinding. he appeared to look for footsteps in the dust. "OMG hope he won't find me," thought Dora. But on he went. He heard a noise further away. Dora followed at a safe distance. Then she heard a loud bang and an oomph! and a thud. she glanced around the corner and saw what looked like mr Ate dragging the punk into a doorway and closing it. WTF was this all about... she decided this was too much for her and she darted back into the stage where the lights appeared on again. she went to the loo, kind of in consternation, where she overheard that the local band would set up some karaoke to pass the time and have some well desired entertainment.